

Course Conceptual Content

The following list contains core concepts from course lectures and readings that you may choose to use in your assignments; these are not the only concepts covered but they do represent the main ones. Your class assignments are opportunities for you to show us what you understand about these concepts through their application to your own gameplay (homework assignments) and your creative projects (unit assignment) throughout the quarter, so use them accordingly. If you want to use a concept not on this list, you need prior approval from a TA.

	Chess	Civ VI	Undertale	WoW	Valorant
Game Definitions					
Salen & Zimmerman definition [Ch.3]	x				
Sid Meier definition [Ch.3]		x			
Suits definition [Ch.3]	x				
Wittgenstein: problem of genre [Ch.3]	x				
Play [Toomey]	x				
Ludus/Paidia [Frasca]	x				
Game Elements					
Camera/Perspective [Ch.5]		x			
Characters [Ch.7]			x	x	
Game Balance [Ch.5]	x				
Mechanics-Dynamics-Aesthetics [MDA]		x			
Representation [Ch.5]	x	x	x	x	x
Rules [Ch.5]	x	x	x		
Constitutive, Operational, Implicit Rules [Salen & Zimmerman]					
Space/Geography [Ch.5]	x	x	x	x	
Time [Ch.5]	x	x	x	x	x
Uncertainty [Ch.3]	x	x			
Narrative Craft & Theory					
Narrative [Ch.7]			x		
Narrative Architecture [Jenkins]			x		
Paradigmatic vs. Narrative Thought [Bruner]			x		
Narrative Empathy Devices [Bruner et al.] – <i>presupposition, subjectification, multiple perspectives, dramatic irony/asymmetric knowledge, psycho-narration, avatar/NPC design for parasocial attachment</i>			x		
Narrative Devices [Ch.7] – <i>pacing, dialogue, quests, cut scenes, artifacts, context, interface, plot structure</i>			x		
Theories & Frameworks					
Cultural Models [Gee]				x	
Deep Play, Thick Description, Interpretive Anthropology [Geertz]	x			x	
Esports [Ch.6]					x

	Chess	Civ VI	Undertale	WoW	Valorant
Flow (Csikszentmihalyi) [Ch.6]	x				
Genesis of Culture [Huizinga]	x				
Procedural Rhetoric [Bogost]		x			
Simulations/Models [SquireBarab]		x			
Translation Model [Latour]		x			
Epistemic Tools		x			
Model-Based Reasoning		x		x	
Involvement, Immersion, Investment [Davidson]		x			x
Game Culture					
Apprenticeship				x	
Centers of Expertise [Squire]		x			
Gendered play spaces [Ch.6]			x		x
Interest driven learning [Steinkuehler]		x		x	
Metaculture [Ch.6]				x	
Motivations [Ch.6]				x	
Participatory Culture		x		x	
Player Types [Bartle]				x	
Third place [Steinkuehler & Williams]				x	x
Toxic Meritocracy				x	x
Yomi [Serlin]	x				
Beyond Games					
Active media vs. active user [Ch.9]					x
Addiction [Ch.9]				x	
Current industry landscape	x				
Hetero/Sexism [Ch.6]	x		x		x
Invisibilization		x			
Popular Art vs High Art (Jenkins) [Ch.3]	x				
Problem of Othering	x	x			x
Social Evolutionism		x			
Technological Determinism		x			
Violence [Ch.9]					x
Toxicity [Davidson]					x
Radicalization Pipeline					x
Social Sciences (Modes of Inquiry)					
Experiment				x	x
Survey	x				x
Qualitative		x		x	
Ethnography	x	x		x	
Interpretive Methods	x		x		

References [in brackets] refer to relevant lecture or readings with chapter [Ch.] references referring to the Egenfeldt-Nielsen, Smith & Tosca textbook *Understanding Video Games*.